

THE MOVE

Civil opener + relevant fact + clear next step or limit. -> Brief: one short paragraph. Informative: facts, not counter-claims. Friendly: civil language, no contempt. Firm: a clear end, boundary, or action. -> Thanks for the update. The report was sent at ?

START HERE

Write three sentences: one civil opening, one factual answer, one firm next step.

SAY THIS

Civil openers	<i>"Thanks for sending this."</i>
Informative facts	<i>"The meeting is scheduled for 3 pm on Thursday."</i>
Friendly bridges	<i>"I appreciate you checking."</i>
Firm closes	<i>"I will not discuss personal accusations by email."</i>
Workplace & custom...	<i>"Thanks for raising this. The agreed scope is the March report and the client deck. I will send both by 2 pm; further scope changes go through the project lead."</i>
Social & family replies	<i>"I hear that you are upset. I can help with the appointment on Friday at 10 am. I am not available for blame by text."</i>

AVOID

- Immediate safety action is needed
- The person is asking for comfort, not attacking you
- You owe a fuller apology, repair, or explanation

REMEMBER

Do not answer the whole storm. Answer the useful weather report.